Little Gems Lentil Salad

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Green lentils make a lovely base for a salad full of crunch and bright, tangy flavour.

Serves 4–6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 30 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SALAD

- 250 g dried green lentils
- 1 cup pomegranate seeds
- 3 spring onions, thinly sliced
- 3 small Lebanese cucumbers, finely diced
- 2 tbsp toasted sesame seeds
- Salt, to taste

FOR THE DRESSING

- 4 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 1 tbsp balsamic cream or glaze
- 1 tbsp pomegranate molasses

METHOD

1. Cook the lentils. Rinse the lentils and place in a saucepan with plenty of water. Bring to the boil, then reduce to a gentle simmer. Cook for approximately 20–30 minutes, or according to the packet instructions, until tender but still holding their shape.
2. Drain thoroughly, spread on a wide plate or tray and leave to cool.
3. Make the dressing. Whisk together the olive oil, balsamic vinegar, balsamic cream and pomegranate molasses.
4. Assemble the salad. Place the cooled lentils in a large bowl with the pomegranate seeds, spring onions and diced cucumbers.
5. Pour over the dressing, season with salt and toss gently until evenly coated.
6. Add most of the toasted sesame seeds and mix lightly. Transfer to a serving dish and scatter the remaining seeds over the top.

Tip

Keep the lentils intact. Simmer gently and begin checking early so they stay tender rather than turning mushy.